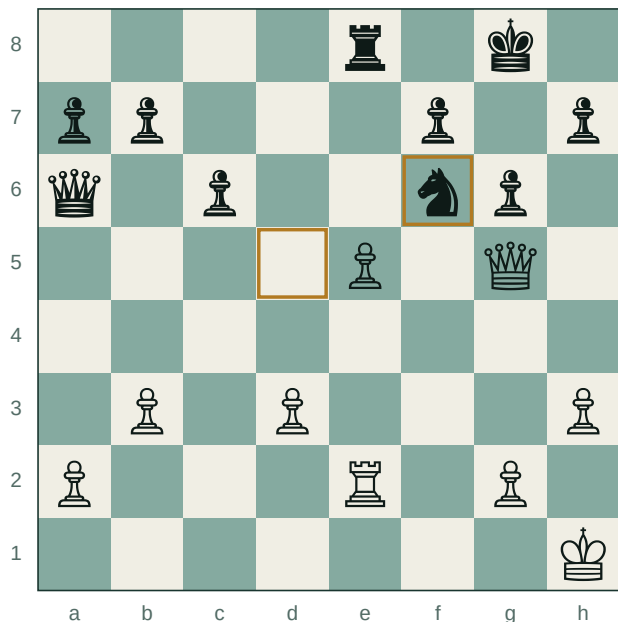


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 29

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 28...Nxf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. exf6 Rxe2 30. Qh6 Re1+ 31. Kh2 Rh1+ 32. Kxh1 c5 33. Qg7#

29.exf6 The pawn captures the knight on f6. The changed line means the rook on e2 attacks the rook on e8. Recorded reply: **29...Rxe2**.

30.Qh6 The queen moves from g5 to h6. Recorded reply: **30...Re1+**.

31.Kh2 The king moves from h1 to h2. Recorded reply: **31...Rh1+**.

32.Kxh1 The king captures the rook on h1. Recorded reply: **32...c5**.

33.Qg7# Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.